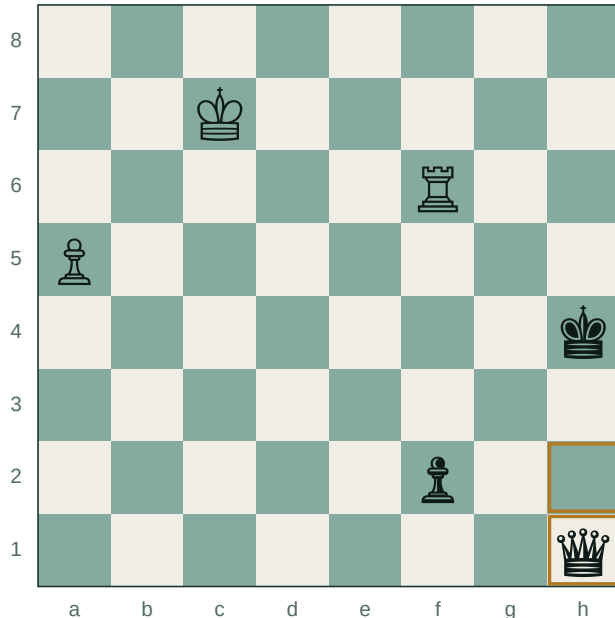


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 63

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 62...h1=Q. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

63. Rh6+ Kg4 64. Rxh1

63.Rh6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **63...Kg4**.

64.Rxh1 The rook captures the queen on h1.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -4 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on h4. Geometrically undefended: queen on h1. Check for tactical protection.